



In the Heart of the USA

- 5 American culture is a fascinating tapestry woven from a variety of influences, including Native American traditions, the heritage of European settlers, African American innovation, Latin American flavors, and more recent Asian influences. This cultural melting pot has created a uniquely
10 vibrant and diverse society.

Passive Voice

1. Jazz music **was encouraged** in the early 20th century by a mix of African rhythms and European harmonies.
2. The American Constitution **was created** to ensure liberty
15 and justice for all.
3. Thanksgiving **is celebrated** on the fourth Thursday of November every year.
4. Hollywood **has been recognized** as the global center of the entertainment industry.
- 20 5. Landmarks such as the Statue of Liberty **are respected** symbols of freedom and democracy.

Grammar Review

Complex Sentence Structures

American English often features complex sentence structures, including the use of subordinating conjunctions (although, because, since, unless, etc.). For example:

- Although the United States **is comprised** of 50 states, it functions as a single nation.
- Because the country **has been populated** by immigrants from around the world, its culture **is characterized** by diversity.

Conditionals and Subjunctive Mood

Understanding American culture also **involves learning** about its expressions through conditional sentences and the subjunctive mood, particularly for discussing hypotheticals and wishes:

- If you **travel to** the United States, you **will see** a variety of cultural influences.
- It's essential that each state **be represented** in the federal government.
- If American inventors **had not developed** certain technologies, modern life **would be different**.

Advanced Verb Tenses

High-level proficiency in American English also requires familiarity with advanced verb tenses, such as perfect tenses and future perfect:

- By the year 2050, several American cities **will have celebrated** their tricentennial anniversaries.

A Taste of American Culture: Corndogs and More

American culture is a rich mosaic of traditions, celebrations, and culinary delights that tell the story of a diverse nation. Among these cultural icons is the humble corndog, a quintessential American snack that perfectly captures the spirit of regional fairs and festivals.

Corndogs

A corndog is a simple yet delightful snack that consists of a hot dog coated in a thick layer of cornmeal batter, which is then deep-fried to golden perfection. It is traditionally served on a stick, making it a convenient and tasty treat for on-the-go enjoyment. Corndogs are often associated with state fairs, amusement parks, and street food vendors, evoking memories of fun and festivity.

Passive Voice Exercises

1. The corndog **was believed** to be invented in the early 20th century in Texas.
2. Every year, thousands of corndogs **are consumed** at the Texas State Fair.
3. The recipe **has been adapted** over time to include various types of sausages and batters.
4. Special sauces and toppings **have been added** by enthusiasts to elevate the classic corndog.

Other Cultural Icons

Apple Pie

75 Another iconic American food is apple pie, often touted as "as American as apple pie." This dessert, with its flaky crust and sweet, spiced apple filling, **is cherished** in American households and **is served** on various holidays, particularly Thanksgiving.

80 American Football

American football is a sport that commands immense fanfare and dedication across the nation. The Super Bowl, the championship game of the National Football League (NFL), **is watched** by millions and **is considered** a significant cultural event, complete with lavish halftime shows and commercials.

The Fourth of July

The Fourth of July, or Independence Day, **is celebrated** with fireworks, parades, and barbecues across the country. It commemorates the signing of the Declaration of Independence
90 in 1776, marking the birth of the United States as an independent nation.

Grammar Review

Relative Clauses

95 Understanding cultural nuances often requires the use of relative clauses to provide additional information:

- The corndog, **which originated** at state fairs, **has become** a symbol of American street food.

- 100 •Apple pie, **which is often served** with a scoop of vanilla ice cream, **is a beloved** American dessert.

Modal Verbs

Talking about American culture also involves the use of modal verbs to express possibility, necessity, and permission:

- To experience a true American fair, you **must try** a corndog.
- 105 •You **might find** regional variations of traditional foods, reflecting the diverse influences across the country.

Gerunds and Infinitives

Using gerunds and infinitives properly is crucial for fluency:

- Eating a corndog **at a fair is considered** a must-do activity.
- 110 •To understand American culture fully, one **needs to explore** both its historical roots and modern expressions.

Phrasal Verbs

- Complete the sentences with the correct phrasal verbs (live up to, put off, run into, take after, pick up, look forward to, break down, give up, turn down, look after):
- 115

- 1.The car _____ on the way to work, and I had to call a mechanic.
- 2.She _____ her mother in her kindness and
- 120 patience.
- 3.I _____ meeting my friend next weekend; it's been a while.
- 4.John _____ a taxi after realizing he'd missed the last bus.

- 125 5. We mustn't _____ today's work till tomorrow.
6. He _____ a job offer because he didn't want to relocate.
7. They _____ their promises and delivered an excellent product.
- 130 8. I _____ my neighbor's cat while she was on vacation.
9. Don't _____! I know you can pass the exam.
10. They _____ each other at the mall and decided to have coffee together.

135 **Perfect Tense**

Complete the sentences with the present perfect or past perfect forms of the verbs in parentheses:

1. I _____ (never/see) such an amazing performance before.
- 140 2. By the time the police arrived, the thief _____ (escape).
3. She _____ (already/read) the book twice.
4. When we arrived at the party, they _____ (already/start) dancing.
- 145 5. This is the first time I _____ (ever/try) sushi.
6. They _____ (know) each other since they were kids.
7. By the time he called, I _____ (finish) my homework.

- 150 8. She _____ (never/been) to Japan before this trip.
9. It _____ (not/rain) this much since last spring.
10. When I woke up, the sun _____ (rise) already.

Comparatives

155 Complete the sentences with the appropriate comparative form of the adjectives in parentheses:

1. This winter is _____ (cold) than the previous one.
2. My new phone is _____ (fast) than my old one.
3. This road is _____ (narrow) than the one we took yesterday.
160 4. She is _____ (happy) now that she has changed jobs.
5. This puzzle is _____ (challenging) than the last one.
6. Tom is _____ (tall) than his brother.
165 7. This dish is _____ (delicious) than the one we had last time.
8. Your house is _____ (far) from the city center than mine.
9. His explanation was _____ (clear) than the teacher's.
170 10. The movie was _____ (exciting) than the book.